

The actions of the government are often a threat to high-income earners who use most of their incomes to support their lifestyles. This is especially true when there is political gain for those in power in targeting the “wealthy.” Actually, the people the politicians are targeting are high-income earners. Most politicians don’t understand the difference between having a high income and having high levels of wealth. They have a more difficult time targeting people with high levels of net worth.

Most millionaires who are PAWs are self-employed. Being self-employed gives one much more control over one’s economic future than does working for others. Conversely, employees today, even high-income-producing executives, have less control over their livelihoods than ever before. Downsizing, for example, is taking its toll, even among the most productive employees. More often than not, even high-income-producing employees are not likely to be millionaires.

UAWs who are employees (not self-employed) are particularly vulnerable to external forces that threaten their ability to earn a living. We found that only 19 percent of PAWs versus 36 percent of high-income-producing nonmillionaires (UAWs) were concerned about having their jobs eliminated (see [Table 3-4](#)). But in spite of the “handwriting” that is often “on the wall,” even most high-income-earning employees are consumption-oriented.